

018. Chapter 2 Verses 48-51

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.48

योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनञ्जय ।
सिद्ध्यसिद्ध्योः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते ॥ 48 ॥

yoga-sthaḥ kuru karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā dhanañjaya
siddhy-asiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā samatvaṁ yoga uchyate

yoga-sthaḥ—being steadfast in yog; **kuru**—perform; **karmāṇi**—duties; **saṅgaṁ**—attachment; **tyaktvā**—having abandoned; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun; **siddhi-asiddhyoḥ**—in success and failure; **samaḥ**—equipoised; **bhūtvā**—becoming; **samatvam**—equanimity; **yogaḥ**—Yog; **uchyate**—is called

O Arjuna! Steadfast in Yoga, giving up all attachment, unmindful of success or failure, do your work. Such equanimity of mind is called Yoga.

VERSE 2.49

दूरेण ह्यवरं कर्म बुद्धियोगाद्धनञ्जय ।
बुद्धौ शरणमन्विच्छ कृपणाः फलहेतवः ॥ ४९ ॥

dūreṇa hy-avarām karma buddhi-yogād dhanañjaya
buddhau śharaṇam anvichchha kṛipaṇāḥ phala-hetavaḥ

dūreṇa—(discreet) from far away; **hi**—certainly; **avarām**—inferior; **karma**—reward-seeking actions; **buddhi-yogāt**—with the intellect established in Divine knowledge; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun; **buddhau**—divine knowledge and insight; **śharaṇam**—refuge; **anvichchha**—seek; **kṛipaṇāḥ**—miserly; **phala-hetavaḥ**—those seeking fruits of their work

O Arjuna! Work with attachment is far inferior to nishkama karma. Therefore seek refuge in desireless action with equanimity of mind. Those who work for fruits and rewards are wrecked.

VERSE 2.50

बुद्धियुक्तो जहातीह उभे सुकृतदुष्कृते ।

तस्माद्योगाय युज्यस्व योगः कर्मसु कौशलम् ॥ 50 ॥

buddhi-yukto jahātiha ubhe sukṛita-duṣhkṛite

tasmād yogāya yujyasva yogaḥ karmasu kauśhalam

buddhi-yuktaḥ—endowed with wisdom; **jahāti**—get rid of; **iha**—in this life; **ubhe**—both; **sukṛita-duṣhkṛite**—good and bad deeds; **tasmāt**—therefore; **yogāya**—for Yog; **yujyasva**—strive for; **yogaḥ**—yog is; **karmasu kauśhalam**—the art of working skillfully

The man of equanimity born of wisdom releases himself both from good and bad even in this life. Therefore strive for nishkama karma with an equal mind. Yoga is skill in action.

VERSE 2.51

कर्मजं बुद्धियुक्ता हि फलं त्यक्त्वा मनीषिणः ।
जन्मबन्धविनिर्मुक्ताः पदं गच्छन्त्यनामयम् ॥ 51 ॥

karma-jam buddhi-yuktā hi phalam tyaktvā manīṣhiṇaḥ
janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ padam gachchhanty-anāmayam

karma-jam—born of fruitive actions; **buddhi-yuktāḥ**—endowed with equanimity of intellect; **hi**—as; **phalam**—fruits; **tyaktvā**—abandoning; **manīṣhiṇaḥ**—the wise; **janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ**—freedom from the bondage of life and death; **padam**—state; **gachchhanti**—attain; **anāmayam**—devoid of sufferings

Wise men endowed with equanimity, having abandoned the fruits of action, go to the abode beyond all sorrow and evil.